

leisurely two-hour affair with guests from Mexico City, New York, New Delhi, or wherever. In the afternoon Nick may take photographs of pollution around Marbella, research a word processor he wants to buy, plan the family's next overseas trip, play tennis, watch his son's soccer game, visit a friend in an old folks' home, or arrange for an art gallery to invite an American sculptor to visit. Dinner is a repeat of lunch, with different guests and hours of leisurely talk. After dinner Nick reads a book, watches TV, or relaxes with his family.

SO YOU WANT TO BE RICH?

If you're a bare-bones retiree (chapter 11), you'll most likely do some part-time work after you retire. You'll need the money. But for the rest of you, whether you earn any money after retiring is purely a matter of choice. I think it's perfectly noble and valid to retire young and never earn another dime the rest of your life. When I retired that was my idea, and I still think it's a good one. On the other hand, some of your retirement activities may earn you some dough. It seems silly to reject an activity just because you might make some money at it.

Your first two years of retirement should be a clean break from your old life. After that you can be more objective in evaluating offers and options. You may decide to go out and look for part-time work in your old profession. But, assuming you choose to work, you're probably more likely to want to try something new. Turn a hobby into a business, start a software company, or make movies. Build a small lab in your garage and invent a new building material. Speculate in commodity futures. Start a plumbing business with your children. Any number of things can make you money. Some may even make you rich.

My friend Chambers Tate taught me how one becomes very rich. Chambers, now 42, spent ten years starting busi-